INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #16 · RELATIVES

“My family will never change.”

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Where it often comes from

Family patterns can feel carved in stone: the same arguments, the same favorites, the same silence about hard things. After years of hoping and trying, it is natural to conclude that nothing will ever be different. Disappointment can turn into resignation or into a quiet bitterness.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “With man this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.” God promises, “I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you.” In Scripture, God changed the hearts of people who seemed hopeless, as in the story of the prodigal son. Proverbs says, “The king’s heart is a waterway in the hand of the LORD; He directs it where He pleases.” At the same time, we are told, “If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone.” We cannot force change, but we can pray, do our part, and keep our own hearts from hardening.

> *“Jesus looked at them and said, ‘With man this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.’”* (Matthew 19:26).

Also see

> “I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; I will remove your heart of stone and give you a heart of flesh” (Ezekiel 36:26).

> “So he got up and went to his father. But while he was still in the distance, his father saw him and was filled with compassion. He ran to his son, embraced him, and kissed him” (Luke 15:20).

> “If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone” (Romans 12:18).

> “The king’s heart is a waterway in the hand of the LORD; He directs it where He pleases” (Proverbs 21:1).

Common self-statements

- They are who they are.
- Nothing I do makes any difference.
- Every holiday is the same.
- They will never see the truth.
- It is pointless to try again.
- I have to accept it forever.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that no change will ever occur.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing change is either total or impossible.
- Mental filter: Focusing on what has not changed and missing small shifts.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling hopeless and concluding it is hopeless.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I want my family to change?
- Has anything shifted over the years, even a little?

- What part of this is mine to change, such as my responses or expectations?
- What can I do differently while I pray for them?
- What does Scripture say about God's power to change hearts?
- How can I protect my own peace?

Truth summary

> I cannot make my family change, but I do not have to give up hope. God can change hearts, and I can change my own responses. I can pray, set healthy limits, and live well whether or not they change.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Forgiveness
- Prayer, Answers to
- Love, For Others
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Depression
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Greater — MercyMe
God's presence and grace challenge shame and the need to win everyone's approval.

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "My family will never change"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My family will never change." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I want to change?
- ☐ What small shifts have I seen?
- ☐ What is mine to change?
- ☐ What will I do differently?
- ☐ How can I pray?
- ☐ How will I protect my peace?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ With God all things are possible.
- ☐ God can give a new heart.
- ☐ I can change my part.
- ☐ I do not have to carry their change.
- ☐ I can pray and hope.
- ☐ I can protect my peace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Matthew 19:26**
  "Jesus looked at them and said, 'With man this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.'"
- ☐ **Ezekiel 36:26**
  "I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; I will remove your heart of stone and give you a heart of flesh."
- ☐ **Romans 12:18**
  "If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ My part: Each week, write one thing you did differently in your own responses.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 19:26 becomes: "Sarah can write: "With God all things are possible, even for my family.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name what you want. Write the specific change you hope for.
- ☐ Divide the control. Write what is yours to change and what is not.
- ☐ Pray by name. Pray for each family member for a week.
- ☐ Adjust your expectations. Decide how you will respond next time without waiting for change.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My family will never change": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	My part changed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My family will never change.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, with You all things are possible. I place my family in Your hands. Change what only You can change, and change me where I need it. Give me peace. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.